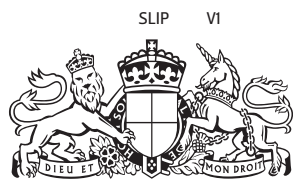


BORIS



People I meet abroad PITY us in Starmer's socialist sogfest

Daily Mail



SATURDAY, JANUARY 25, 2025

dailymail.co.uk

£1.60

£1.30 to subscribers

SCAN TO
SUBSCRIBE
AND SAVE



£100,000

Jet2holidays® giveaway

50 holidays to be won



SEE PAGE 20
ONLINE ACCESS REQUIRED.

LABOUR TAXES LEAVE FIRMS IN 'DIRE SITUATION'

Thousands of companies struggling to survive, report warns

From **John-Paul Ford Rojas**
Deputy Business Editor, in Davos

THE number of firms on the brink of collapse has surged under Labour.

Rachel Reeves was last night warned that her tax-raising Budget threatens to push many over the edge following an unprecedented 50 per cent rise in businesses in 'critical financial distress'.

Separate figures yesterday showed private-sector jobs falling in January at the fastest pace since 2009 – excluding the pandemic – in another blow for the beleaguered Chancellor.

Insolvency specialist Begbies Traynor said Labour's £25billion raid on employers' National Insurance and a hike in the minimum wage in the Budget could be the 'last straw' for many firms struggling with weak consumer confidence and high borrowing costs.

'For many of these companies, the situation

Turn to Page 2



Faithful to the end... 'Army Barbie' shares win on Traitors

SEE PAGE 12